

Analysis of the Gymnastics Competition Scores of the Participants of National School Games Artistic Gymnastics Championships, 2019

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ABSTRACT

National School Games Gymnastics Competitions are conducted by the SGFI almost every year. It is the biggest Gymnastic Competition in India in which approximately 1000 players participate in Men and Women Artistic Gymnastics Competitions. Looking at the number of participants it seems very encouraging. But looking at the low Performance standard of the School Games Gymnastics Competition, it is very disheartening. The present investigation was conducted to find out that how many %age of players scored 80% or above, how many 70% and above how many 50% and above and so on. The data and performance results were obtained from the Official Result Book of the SGFI and analysed. It was observed that out of 464 participants in Women Artistic Gymnastics (WAG), 66 girls (14.22 %) did not obtain any point. They obtained ZERO Score in All Around Competitions and were still eligible to get the participation certificate. The National Federations must keep some basic performance standard and basic cut off points criteria to award the participation Certificate.

INTRODUCTION

There are very few Gymnastics Competitions which are organized at All India level. Some of the Gymnastics Competitions organised at National level are National Gymnastics Championships organized by the Gymnastics Federation of India, National School Games Gymnastics Competition organized by the School Games Federation of India, All India Inter University Gymnastics Championships, organized by the Association of Indian Universities. In

addition to this some departments also organize Gymnastics Competitions for its employees such as All India Police Gymnastics Competitions, Inter-services Gymnastics Competition, Inter Railways Gymnastics Competition etc.

National School Games Gymnastics Competition in MAG, WAG, RG and Acrobatic Gymnastics is organized by the SGFI every year. This is the biggest competition where in the large number of gymnasts participate. School Games

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Federation of India conducts the National School Games Gymnastics Competition in three age groups, i.e., under 14 years of age group, 17 years of age group and 19 years of age group.

Looking at the number of participants in each Sport Discipline in each Age Group it seems that Gymnastic is quite popular in India, as the number of the participants is quite large in each age group. But when we look at the Competition Result Scores of the gymnasts on each Event a completely different scenario is seen. Competition performance standard is extremely low. It has been observed that some States/ participating Units bring such participants who just come for enjoying and participating in the Competition without even knowing the ABC of Gymnastics. They obtain ZERO Score. They just come on the FOP, touch the apparatus and go back without performing any movement.

Women Artistic gymnastics is a discipline of gymnastics in which athletes perform short routines on four different apparatuses, i.e., Vault, Uneven bars, Beam and Floor. The sport is governed by the Fédération Internationale de Gymnastique (FIG), which designs the Code of Points and regulates all aspects of international competition. Gymnastics Competition of the National School Games under 14 years of age Groups was conducted as per the Rules of Gymnastics Federation of India (GFI 2011) and

Gymnastics Competition of the National School Games under 17 years and 19 years of age groups was conducted as per WAG Code of Points by FIG (FIG CoP 2017-2020 edition).

PURPOSE OF THE STUDY:

The present investigation has been carried out to find out the performance standard of the Gymnasts participating in this competition and the performance Scores they achieve on Various Events in the Competition.

METHODOLOGY:

The present investigation was conducted on the 464 women athletes who participated in the National School Games Gymnastics Competition held in November, 2019, under 14 years, 17 years and 19 years age groups.

The performances on each apparatus were evaluated by the qualified International Judges, National Judges and Judges of SGFI appointed by the SGFI. Performances under 14 years of age groups in Women Artistic Gymnastics were evaluated as per the rules and regulations of GFI (2011). Performances in Women Artistic Gymnastics under 17 and 19 years of age groups were evaluated as per the FIG WAG Code of Points (2017-2020),

The Competition Performance Scores of each gymnast participating on each Event in the National School Games Gymnastics Competition, 2019 held in Agra, were obtained from the Official Result booklet of the SGFI.

In Women Artistic Gymnastics, under the 14 years of age group, a maximum of 17.00 points on each apparatus can be achieved by a gymnast in Individual Apparatus Finals and a maximum of 68.00 points in All Around Individual Competition.

To analyze the Competition Performance standard of the participants in Women Artistic Gymnast it was computed that how many gymnasts achieved ZERO marks, how many from 0.6 to 5.00 points, how many from 5.1-10.00 points, how many from 10.1 to 20.00 points, how many from 20.1 to 30.00 points, how many from 30.1 to 40.00 points, how many from 41.1 to

50.00 points, how many above 50.00 points, in All Around Competition. To analyse the performance Scores standard on each Event in WAG, it was computed that how many gymnasts achieved ZERO marks, how many obtained from 0.6 to 2.0 points, how many from 2.1 to 4.00 points, how many from 4.1 to 6.00 points, how many from 6.1 to 8.0 points, how many from 8.1 to 10.0 points, how many from 10.1 to 12.00 points, and how many above 14.00 points in Individual Apparatus Finals.

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

The results obtained by applying the above methodology are presented in the following Tables.

Table-1: Marks Obtained by The Gymnasts in Individual All Around Competition (IAAC) in National School Games 2019

Marks Obtained Category		Zero Points	0.60 Pt To 5.00 Pt	5.10 Pt To 10.00 Pt	10.10 Pt To 20.00 Pt	20.10 Pt To 30.00 Pt	30.10 Pt To 40.00 Pt	40.10 Pt To 45.50 Pt	Above 45.5 Pt.	Maximum Marks	Total No. of Participants
WAG UNDER 14 YEARS	N	22	28	20	38	22	40	10	-	68.00	180
	%	12.2%	15.6 %	11.1 %	21.1 %	12.2 %	22.2 %	5.5 %	0.00 %		
WAG UNDER 17 YEARS	N	18	28	8	35	40	27	5	-	68.00	161
	%	11.2%	17.5%	5.0%	21.8%	25.0%	16.9%	3.1%	0.00%		
WAG UNDER 19 YEARS	N	26	32	4	8	28	23	3	-	68.00	124
	%	21.0%	25.8%	3.2%	6.4%	22.6%	18.6%	2.4%	0.00%		

The above Table (Table-1) depicts the scores achieved by the Gymnasts under 14 years, under 17 years and under 19 years of age groups in All Around

Competition in Women Artistic Gymnastics.

Table-1 indicates that out of 180 participants under 14 years of age group

in WAG, 22 girls (12.22% participants) scored 0.00 points (ZERO), 28 Gymnasts (15.5% participants) scored 0.6 to 5.0 points, 20 gymnasts (11.11% participants) scored 5.1 to 10.0 points, 38 gymnasts (21.1% participants) scored 10.1 to 20.0 points, 22 gymnasts (12.22% participants) scored 20.1 to 30.0 points, 40 gymnasts (22.22% participants) scored 30.1 to 40.0 points and 10 gymnasts (5.55 % participants) scored 40.1 to 45.5 points out of 68.0 points which come to 66.9%. Not even a single gymnast was able to score more than 66.9% marks.

From the above Table it is observed that in the age group under 17 years in WAG, out of 161 participants, 18 girls (11.2% participants) scored 0.00 point (ZERO), 28 gymnasts (17.5% participants) scored 0.60 to 5.0 points, 8 gymnasts (5% participants) scored 5.10 to 10.0 points, 35 gymnasts (21.8 % participants) scored 10.1 to 20.0 points, 40 gymnasts (25% participants) 20.1 to 30.0 points, 27 gymnasts (16.9% participants) scored 30.1 to 40.0 points and only 4 gymnasts (2.5% participants) scored 40.1 to 50.0 points. The results in the above Table show that the performance standard under 17 years of girls was quite low as only 4 gymnasts could obtain scores from 40.10 to 41.2 point out of a maximum of 68.00 points which comes to only 60.5%. Not even a single gymnast was able to score more than 60.5% marks.

It is evident from the above Table that 26 gymnast out of 124 participants (21% participants) under 19 years of age group in WAG, scored 0.00 points (ZERO) in Individual All Around Competition, 32 gymnasts (25.8 % participants) scored 0.60 to 5.0 points, 4 gymnasts (3.2% participants) scored 5.10 to 10.0 points, 8 gymnasts (6.4% participants) scored 10.10 to 20.0 points, 28 gymnasts (22.6% participants) scored 20.1 to 30.0 points, 23 gymnasts (18.5% participants) scored 30.10 to 40.00 points and only 3 gymnasts (2.4% participants) scored 40.10 to 50.00 points. The results in the above Table show that the performance standard under 19 years of girls was also quite low as only 3 gymnasts could obtain scores from 40.10 to 45.2 points out of a maximum of 68.00 points which comes to only 66.50 %.

Such a disastrous results are not seen when we look at the results of the National Gymnastics Championships in Russia (2021 Russian Artistic Gymnastics Championships) and National Gymnastics Championships in USA (results/2021/usa-championships).

It is very astonishing to see those 22 girls under 14 years of age, 18 girls under 17 years of age and 26 girls under 19 years of age in WAG (Totalling to 66 Girls out of 464 participants in WAG, 14.3% participants) who scored 0.00 points in All Around Competition were also eligible to get participation Certificate.

It is a matter of further investigation

that how such players who obtain ZERO Score in All Around Competition (on combined all the 4 apparatuses) get selected in their State / School boards Teams for participating in the National Level Competition?

There results of the players on the Individual Events (Individual Apparatus Finals), which are given in the following Tables, may give even a greater shock.

Table-2: Marks Obtained by the Gymnasts (No. of Gymnasts & their % age) under 14 years in Various Events in WAG in National School Games, 2019

Event	Points Obtained	Zero Points	0.60 Pt To 2.00 Pt	2.10 Pt To 4.00Pt	4.10 Pt To 6.00Pt	6.10 Pt To 8.00Pt	8.10 Pt To 10.00Pt	10.10 Pt To 12.00Pt	12.10 Pt To 12.50Pt	Maximum Marks	Total No. of Participants
VAULT	N	112	-	-	-	5	46	24	-	17.00	187
	%	59.9%				2.7%	24.6%	12.9%			
UNEVEN BARS	N	92	13	15	13	32	19	4	-	17.00	188
	%	48.9%	6.9%	8.0%	6.9%	17.0%	10.1%	2.1%			
BEAM	N	75	6	9	15	28	38	16	1	17.00	188
	%	39.9%	3.1%	4.8%	8.0%	14.9%	20.2%	8.5%	0.5		
FLOOR	N	33	19	4	5	46	40	30	7	17.00	186
	%	17.7%	10.2%	2.2%	2.7%	24.7%	21.5%	16.1%	3.7%		

The results in the above Table show that 112 girls out of 187 participants (59.9 %) got ZERO Marks in Vault Event. It is too big a number and poor performance. It is also evident from the above Table that not even a single gymnast could obtain morethan12.0 points in Vault.

Results of the Uneven bars in the above Table indicate that performance on Uneven bars was even worse than the performance on Table Vault. 92 participants (39.9%) got ZERO marks, and 13 gymnasts (6.9 %) got 0.6 to 2.0 points. Only 4 gymnasts, (only 2.1% of

participants), could get from 10.1 to 11.2 points. There was not a single gymnast who obtained more than11.2 points i.e.,65.8% marks.

Looking at the results of the Beam Event, it is evident from the above Table that 75 gymnasts out of 188 participants (39.9% gymnasts) got 0.00 Points. 6 gymnasts (3.1% gymnasts) scored 0.6 to 2.0 points, 9 gymnasts obtained 2.1 to 4.0 points, 15 gymnasts got 4.1 to 6.0 points, 28 gymnasts got 6.1 to 8.0 points, 38 gymnasts achieved 8.1 to 10.0 points, 16 Gymnasts obtained 10.1 to 12.0 points

and only 1 gymnast could get a maximum of 12.30 points.

It is evident from the above Table that in Floor Event, 33 gymnasts (17.7 % participants) out of 188 participants got ZERO point. 19 gymnasts (10.2% gymnasts) scored 0.6 to 2.0 points, 4

gymnasts obtained 2.1 to 4.0 points, 5 gymnasts got 4.1 to 6.0 points, 46 gymnasts got 6.1 to 8.0 points, 40 gymnasts achieved 8.1 to 10.0 points, 30 Gymnasts obtained 10.1 to 12.0 points and 7 gymnasts scored from 12.1 to 12.45 points.

Table-3: Marks Obtained by the Gymnasts (No. of Gymnasts & their % age) under 17 years in Various Events in WAG in National School Games, 2019

Points Obtained Event		Zero Points	0.60 Pt To 2.00 Pt	2.10 Pt To 4.00 Pt	4.10 Pt To 6.00 Pt	6.10 Pt To 8.00 Pt	8.10 Pt To 10.00 Pt	10.10 Pt To 12.00 Pt	12.10 Pt To 12.50 Pt	Maximum Marks	Total No. of Participants
VAULT	N	60	-	-	-	29	45	21	2	17.00	157
	%	38.2%	-	-	-	18.5%	28.7%	13.4%	1.3%		
UNEVEN BARS	N	72	41	1	9	30	5	-	-	17.00	158
	%	45.9%	26.1 %	0.06 %	5.7 %	19.0 %	3.10 %				
BEAM	N	61	12	7	9	34	25	7	1	17.00	156
	%	39.1%	7.7%	4.5%	5.8%	21.8%	16.0%	4.5%	0.6%		
FLOOR	N	30	15	17	11	41	27	17	-	17.00	158
	%	19.0%	9.5%	10.7%	6.9%	26.0%	17.1%	10.7%			

Marks obtained by the gymnasts, under 17 years of age group, are presented in the above Table. It is evident from the above Table that in Vault Event, 60 gymnasts (38.2 % participants) out of 157 participants got ZERO point. Only 2 gymnasts (1.3% participants) scored a maximum of 12.8 points on Vault.

Results of the Uneven bars in the above Table indicate that performance on Uneven bars was even worse than the performance on Table Vault. 72 participants (45.9 %) out of 158 participants got ZERO marks, and 5 gymnasts (3.1 % participants) got a

maximum of 8.8 points (only 50.2% marks). There was not a single gymnast who obtained more than 8.8 points i.e., 50.2% marks.

Looking at the results of the Beam Event, it is evident from the above Table that 61 gymnasts out of 158 participants (39.1% gymnasts) got 0.00 Points. 12 gymnasts (7.7% gymnasts) scored 0.6 to 2.0 points, 7 gymnasts obtained 2.1 to 4.0 points, 9 gymnasts got 4.1 to 6.0 points, 34 gymnasts got 6.1 to 8.0 points, 25 gymnasts achieved 8.1 to 10.0 points, 7 Gymnasts obtained 10.1 to 12.0 points and only 1 gymnast could get a maximum

of 12.15 points.

The results in the above Table show that 30 girls out of 158 participants (19.0 %) got ZERO Marks in Floor Event. 15 gymnasts (9.3 %) scored 0.6 to 2.0, 17 gymnasts obtained 2.1 to 4.0 points, 11 gymnasts got 4.1 to 6.0 points, 41

gymnasts got 6.1 to 8.0 points, 27 gymnasts achieved 8.1 to 10.0 points, and 17 Gymnasts obtained 10.1 to 12.0 points. Not even a single gymnast was able to get more than 11.45 points in Floor.

Table-4: Marks Obtained by the Gymnasts (No. of Gymnasts & their % age) under 19 years in Various Events in WAG in National School Games, 2019

Event	Points Obtained	Zero Points	0.60 Pt To 2.00 Pt	2.10 Pt To 4.00 Pt	4.10 Pt To 6.00 Pt	6.10 Pt To 8.00 Pt	8.10 Pt To 10.00 Pt	10.10 Pt To 12.00 Pt	12.10 Pt To 12.50 Pt	Maximum Marks	Total No. of Participants
VAULT	N	66	-	-	-	8	26	19	4	17.00	123
	%	53.7%	-	-	-	6.5%	21.1%	13.5%	3.2%		
UNEVEN BARS	N	71	15	4	5	22	6	-	-	17.00	123
	%	57.7 %	12.2 %	3.2 %	4.6 %	17.9 %	4.9 %				
BEAM	N	60	19	4	-	17	20	3	-	17.00	123
	%	48.8 %	15.5%	2.6%	-	13.8%	16.2%	2.5%			
FLOOR	N	29	21	11	17	16	17	9	3	17.00	123
	%	23.6 %	17.1%	8.9 %	13.8 %	13.0 %	13.80 %	7.3%	2.4 %		

The results in the above Table show that 66 girls out of 123 participants (53.7 %) got ZERO Marks in Vault Event. It is too big a number and poor performance. It is also evident from the above Table that not even a single gymnast could obtain more than 12.9 points in Vault.

Performance on Uneven bars was even worse than the performance on Table Vault which is evident from the above Table (Table-4). 71 participants out of 123 gymnasts (57.7 %) got ZERO marks, and 15 gymnasts (12.2 %) got 0.6 to 2.0 points. Uneven bars is the weakest event when compared with the

performance on other events. About 75% participants could not obtain more than 5.00 points. The highest score obtained by the first ranking gymnast on Uneven bars was 9.05 points. There was not a single gymnast who obtained more than 9.05 points out of a maximum of 17.00 points.

Looking at the results of the Beam Event, it is evident from the above Table that 60 gymnasts out of 123 participants (48.8% gymnasts) got 0.00 Points. 19 gymnasts (15.5% gymnasts) scored 0.6 to 2.0 points, 4 gymnasts obtained 2.1 to 4.0 points, 17 gymnasts got 6.1 to 8.0 points,

20 gymnasts achieved 8.1 to 10.0 points, 3 Gymnasts obtained 10.1 to 12.0 points. There was not a single gymnast who obtained more than 11.90 points out of a maximum of 17.00 points on Beam.

It is evident from the above Table that in Floor Event, 29 gymnasts (23.6 % participants) out of 123 participants got ZERO point. 21 gymnasts (17.1% gymnasts) scored 0.6 to 2.0 points, 11 gymnasts (8.9%) obtained 2.1 to 4.0 points, 17 gymnasts got 4.1 to 6.0 points, 16 gymnasts got 6.1 to 8.0 points, 17 gymnasts (13.8%) achieved 8.1 to 10.0 points, 9 Gymnasts obtained 10.1 to 12.0 points and 3 gymnasts (2.4%) scored from 12.1 to 12.30 points. Not even a single gymnast was able to obtain more than 12.30 points.

CONCLUSION

From the above results and discussion, it may be concluded that though the number of participations in the

National School Games Women Gymnastics Competition is quite high and encouraging yet the performance standard is very low and discouraging. 66 participants (14.3 %), out of 464, got ZERO mark in All Around Scores (combined scores on 4 apparatuses). Even after getting 0.00 points (ZERO) they were eligible to get participation Certificates of National Level Competition. Similar results were also observed in Rhythmic Gymnastics and Men Artistic Gymnastics. The National Level Competition organizing Federations/ Organizations may consider keeping a minimum performance standard/ cut off points for awarding the participation certificates.

It is a matter of further investigation that how did the State School Associations/ Boards select such low performance players for a National Level Competitions?

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